We staked TMC.
Bengal voted otherwise.

DECISION INFRASTRUCTURE · 4 MAY 2026

Simulatte

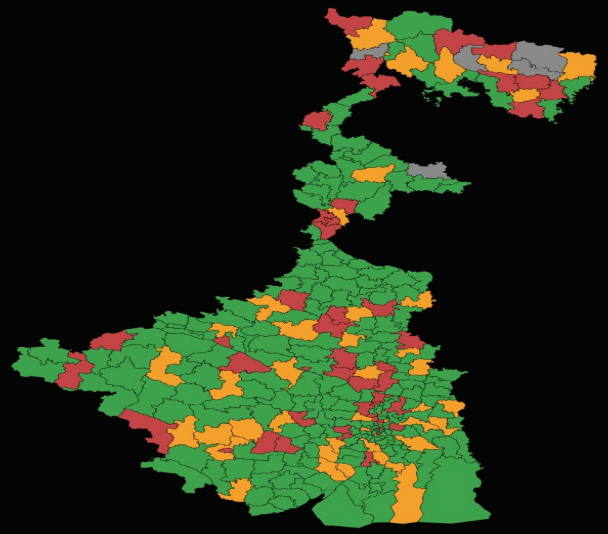
Every party landed outside the band.

TMC	BJP	LEFT + CONG	OTHERS
PREDICTED	PREDICTED	PREDICTED	PREDICTED
194 ± 10	45 ± 10	50 ± 10	5 ± 3
ACTUAL	ACTUAL	ACTUAL	ACTUAL
84	**203**	**6**	**1**
−110	+158	−44	−4

BJP voteshare 45.1% (modelled ~22%) · TMC 41.0% (modelled ~52%)

We staked TMC. Bengal voted otherwise.

PREDICTED

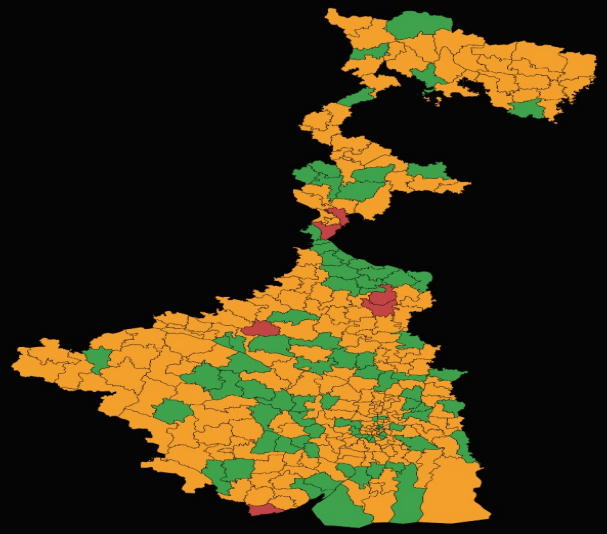


TMC 194 · BJP 45 · INDI 50 · OTH 5

TMC majority by +47

Vote share: TMC 52% · BJP 22%

ACTUAL



BJP 203 · TMC 84 · INDI 6 · OTH 1

BJP majority by +55

Vote share: BJP 45.1% · TMC 41.0%

What the simulation got wrong.

01 **2021 baseline anchored every seat projection.**

The model over-weighted the 2021 anti-BJP correction. BJP's organisational depth and Hindu consolidation reversed that swing statewide — we had no prior encoding this.

02 **CAA modelled as Matua backlash — it was Matua reward.**

We expected Matua grievance over delayed citizenship delivery. The community instead credited BJP for CAA passage; our voteshare prior for Nadia/N24Pgs was ~20pp off.

03 **Muslim vote modelled as a unified TMC bloc.**

4-way fragmentation (AIMIM, AJUP, AISF, independents) in Kolkata, Malda and presidency seats handed BJP pluralities in seats we had TMC leading by 8–12pp.

04 **Global voteshare prior: BJP ~22%, TMC ~52%.**

Actual: BJP 45.1%, TMC 41.0%. A ~20pp miss on BJP voteshare propagated through every cluster model. The prior came from 2021 assembly, not from 2024 Lok Sabha signals.

What no dataset could see.

01 **Voter-roll revisions under SIR were not captured in our population data.**

Name deletions across multiple blocks in North Bengal and Murshidabad created a turnout asymmetry our population layer did not account for. No per-block attrition signal was available at modelling time.

02 **Anti-incumbency depth was qualitative, not quantifiable.**

Sandeshkhali incidents, teacher recruitment scam, post-2021 booth violence — each individually measurable, but the compounding effect on swing was not. No composite index existed.

03 **The mobilisation frame shifted from welfare delivery to political consolidation.**

The simulation's signal layer was built on scheme reach and beneficiary satisfaction. The dominant operative dynamic on election day was cross-community political consolidation — a frame welfare metrics cannot proxy.

04 **BJP booth-level expansion was silent and unmeasured.**

Shakha density, worker count, mobilisation capacity — none are in any public dataset. The silent voter mobilisation differential vs 2021 was the largest single unmodelled variable.

What changes next.

01 **Re-weight priors toward Lok Sabha over assembly cycles.**

Per-cluster Bayesian prior will weight 2024 + 2019 Lok Sabha results at 60%, 2021 assembly at 40%. Assembly corrections now treated as transient, not structural.

02 **SIR deletion rate as a structural population feature.**

Add voter-roll attrition signal to the Niobe population layer — per-block deletion rate as a suppression proxy, especially in Muslim-majority geographies.

03 **Anti-incumbency composite index.**

Build a scored index: scandal exposure × media intensity + violence incidents + service delivery gap score. Feed as a cluster-level adjustment on top of base voteshare.

04 **Replace uniform swing with cluster-bounded correction.**

Each cluster treated independently with its own volatility ceiling. No statewide uniform-swing assumption. Cluster-level MAE from WB 2026 becomes the seed prior for the next study.